

§11.4.140 — Draft anchor text + consumer mirror

Field	Value
Revision	1
Created	2026-06-09
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Status	draft (for operator review before landing in Constitution.md)
Scope	full §11.4.140 anchor + shorter CLAUDE.md/AGENTS.md/QWEN.md/GEMINI.md consumer mirror
Inputs	RESEARCH.md, DESIGN.md (this directory)

NOTE: this is DRAFT text written to research/ per the task scope. It is NOT applied to Constitution.md / CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md / QWEN.md in this run (no commit/push/edit of the live governance files). The operator lands it via the §11.4.26 constitution-update pipeline.

A. FULL anchor — to add as a new ### §11.4.140 ... section in Constitution.md

§11.4.140 — Universal action-prefix system (ACTION_NAME ::) (User mandate, 2026-06-09)

Forensic anchor — verbatim user mandate (2026-06-09):

“When a user prompt STARTS with ACTION_NAME :: (e.g. BACKGROUND :: IMPORTANT: do X...) the agent MUST replace the ACTION_NAME :: prefix with that action’s registered expansion text, then execute the rest. For BACKGROUND :: the expansion is: ‘The following prompt that we will provide MUST BE executed in background in parallel with all main work streams using the subagents-driven development approach! All work done MUST PRODUCE rock

solid evidence covered with hard physical proof(s) that all done is working as expected and as specified without any false results and without any bluff!'. The mechanism **MUST** be **UNIVERSAL/extendible** — more actions will be added later, each with its own expansion + rules. It **MUST** work with **EVERY** CLI agent, be fully decoupled + reusable by every project that includes the constitution submodule, and load + execute out of the box."

Every project under this Constitution **MUST** support a universal, extendible **action-prefix system**: when a user prompt's **FIRST** non-blank line starts with an uppercase action token followed by " :: " (grammar `^[A-Z][A-Z0-9_]*`) :: — anchored at line start, UPPERCASE-only token, exactly one space on each side of ::), the agent **MUST** (1) look the token up in the shared **action registry** (tracked data file `constitution/actions/registry.yaml`, or `$HELIX_ACTION_REGISTRY`); (2) if the token is a registered action, **REPLACE** the `ACTION_NAME :: prefix` with that action's registered expansion text and apply its rules; (3) execute the **REMAINDER** of the prompt under the expanded instruction. The system is the C-preprocessor expand-then-rescan model applied to prompts (a line-anchored single-token macro): detect → substitute the registered expansion → execute the residual.

Two-layer architecture (both mandatory; LAYER 1 is the universal floor). (LAYER 1 — universal, always-on, out-of-the-box) the action-prefix recognition instruction **MUST** be mirrored into **EVERY** agent context carrier the constitution maintains (`CLAUDE.md`, `AGENTS.md`, `QWEN.md`, `GEMINI.md` per §11.4.35) so the agent itself recognises and applies the prefix on every CLI agent — Claude Code, Gemini CLI, Qwen Code, OpenAI Codex CLI, GitHub Copilot CLI, Cursor, Aider, Cline, Continue, Roo Code, and any future agent that reads one of those carriers. (LAYER 2 — mechanical, where the agent exposes a pre-submit seam) a prompt-preprocessing hook reading the **SAME** registry applies the expansion deterministically (Claude Code `UserPromptSubmit / UserPromptExpansion` hook injecting the expansion via `additionalContext`; per-agent slash-command equivalents generated from the registry for Gemini/Qwen/Codex). LAYER 2 is the §11.4.109 anti-forgetting upgrade applied to prompt prefixes — the expansion holds even if model recall lapses; LAYER 1 guarantees the system works everywhere with zero extra setup. Honest §11.4.3 boundary (§11.4.6): transparent mechanical free-form `^PREFIX ::` interception is genuinely available **ONLY** on Claude Code today; on every other agent the free-form form is honoured by LAYER 1 (the agent self-applies) and the slash-command equivalent is the mechanical convenience — this split is documented, never papered over.

Grammar (mandatory, all hold). (1) Anchored at the start of the first non-blank line **ONLY**; mid-prose tokens never match. (2) UPPERCASE-only token `[A-Z][A-Z0-9_]*`; lowercase never

matches. (3) Separator is exactly " :: " (space-colon-colon-space) — avoids C++ Foo::Bar, YAML key: value, URLs. (4) Stacked prefixes (A :: B :: rest) apply outer-to-inner, left-to-right (expand A, rescan, expand B, then the residual is the task). (5) A leading \ escapes the prefix (literal, no expansion) so action names can be discussed. (6) An unknown token that matches the grammar shape but is NOT registered is NEVER silently expanded or silently dropped — the agent asks which registered action was meant (§11.4.66 + §11.4.105) or treats it literally; it NEVER invents an expansion (§11.4.6). (7) Any prompt not satisfying the grammar is an ordinary prompt; the system is a no-op.

Registry is the single source of truth + the extension

contract. Adding a new action = adding ONE actions[] row (name, version, summary ≥6 words per §11.4.91, expansion, optional rules + composes_with) — no code change in either layer (the registry is data, not code). Both layers read the same file (§11.4.93-style single-source-of-truth). The first registry entry is BACKGROUND with the operator's verbatim expansion above; it composes §11.4.20/ §11.4.70 (subagent-driven), §11.4.58/§11.4.103 (parallel streams), §11.4.89 (background execution), and §11.4.5/§11.4.69/§11.4.107 (captured physical evidence) + §11.4 (anti-bluff). Decoupled + reusable (§11.4.28): the registry + hook + expander carry zero project-specific data and are consumed by reference (the §11.4.80 codegraph_* pattern); a consuming project ships its own registry or inherits the constitution default. Loads out-of-the-box via the §11.4.75 install seam.

Classification: universal (§11.4.17). Composes §11.4 / §11.4.5 / §11.4.6 / §11.4.17 / §11.4.20 / §11.4.28 / §11.4.35 / §11.4.58 / §11.4.66 / §11.4.69 / §11.4.70 / §11.4.75 / §11.4.80 / §11.4.89 / §11.4.91 / §11.4.93 / §11.4.103 / §11.4.105 / §11.4.107 / §11.4.109. Propagation gate CM-COVENANT-114-140-PROPAGATION (literal 11.4.140 across the consumer fleet) + recommended gate CM-ACTION-PREFIX-SYSTEM (registry exists + parses + the grammar regex matches/no-matches the canonical fixtures + the LAYER-1 mirror block is present in CLAUDE.md/AGENTS.md/QWEN.md/GEMINI.md + the BACKGROUND expansion text matches the registry verbatim + the Claude UserPromptSubmit hook + expander script exist and are executable) + paired §1.1 meta-test mutation (corrupt the BACKGROUND expansion in the registry OR strip the prefix_regex OR remove the LAYER-1 mirror block from one carrier → the gate FAILs; strip the literal 11.4.140 → the propagation gate FAILs; gate-code = separate work item).

Canonical authority: constitution submodule Constitution.md §11.4.140. Non-compliance is a release blocker. No escape hatch — no --skip-action-prefix, --ignore-prefix, --no-registry, --invent-expansion-OK, --single-layer-only flag.

B. SHORTER consumer mirror — to add to CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md / QWEN.md / GEMINI.md

(One block, identical text in all four carriers — that identity IS the LAYER-1 universality. Verbatim BACKGROUND expansion is inlined so the most-used action works out-of-the-box even without registry-file access.)

§11.4.140 — Universal action-prefix system (ACTION_NAME ::) (User mandate, 2026-06-09). When a user prompt's FIRST non-blank line starts with an uppercase action token followed by " :: " (grammar $\wedge([A-Z][A-Z0-9_]*):$), you MUST: (1) look the token up in the action registry constitution/actions/registry.yaml (or \$HELIX_ACTION_REGISTRY); (2) if it is a registered action, REPLACE the ACTION_NAME :: prefix with that action's expansion text and apply its rules; (3) execute the remainder of the prompt under the expanded instruction. Grammar: anchored at the first non-blank line only; UPPERCASE-only token; separator exactly " :: "; stacked prefixes (A :: B :: rest) apply outer-to-inner; a leading \ escapes the prefix (literal, no expansion); an unknown grammar-shaped token is NEVER silently expanded or dropped — ask which registered action was meant (§11.4.66 / §11.4.105) or treat it literally, NEVER invent an expansion (§11.4.6). The registered action **BACKGROUND** expands to: *"The following prompt that we will provide MUST BE executed in background in parallel with all main work streams using the subagents-driven development approach! All work done MUST PRODUCE rock solid evidence covered with hard physical proof(s) that all done is working as expected and as specified without any false results and without any bluff!"* (composes §11.4.20 / §11.4.70 subagent-driven, §11.4.58 / §11.4.103 parallel streams, §11.4.89 background execution, §11.4.5 / §11.4.69 / §11.4.107 captured physical evidence, §11.4 anti-bluff). The system is UNIVERSAL (every CLI agent reads this block via its context carrier per §11.4.35), extensible (new action = new registry row), decoupled + reusable (§11.4.28), and loads out-of-the-box. Classification: universal (§11.4.17). **Canonical authority:** constitution submodule Constitution.md §11.4.140. Non-compliance is a release blocker. No escape hatch — no --skip-action-prefix, --ignore-prefix, --no-registry, --invent-expansion-OK, --single-layer-only flag.

C. Landing checklist (for the operator, via §11.4.26 pipeline)

1. `git fetch + git pull --ff-only` in the constitution submodule (§11.4.26 step 1 / §11.4.37).
2. Add §11.4.140 (Part A) to Constitution.md; add the mirror (Part B) to CLAUDE.md, AGENTS.md, QWEN.md, and a new GEMINI.md (the GEMINI.md carrier is added by this anchor so Gemini CLI gets the LAYER-1 floor).
3. Land `actions/registry.yaml + actions/SCHEMA.md + scripts/hooks/action-prefix-expand.sh + scripts/actions/expand_prefix.sh`
 - `scripts/actions/gen_agent_commands.sh` per DESIGN.md §2.
4. Wire CM-COVENANT-114-140-PROPAGATION + CM-ACTION-PREFIX-SYSTEM gates + the §1.1 paired mutations (TEST_PLAN.md).
5. Re-export `.html/.pdf/.docx` siblings per §11.4.65; bump revision header per §11.4.44; sync the consumer fleet per §11.4.35.
6. Commit + push to ALL upstreams per §11.4.26 step 4 / §2.1 (no force-push per §11.4.113).